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**Study on Translation Strategies of Su Shi's
Poems from the Perspective of
Medio-Translatology**

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摘 要

近年来,在“中国文化走出去”战略思想的指导下,通过对经典诗词的译介与传播来弘扬传统文化的博大精深,使之为愈来愈多的国际友人接受与喜爱,是广大译者义不容辞的职责。然而,迥异、复杂的历史背景直接导致经典诗词在“走出去”过程中屡现误读和扭曲,由此而产生的一系列译介模式值得学术界进行深度解读。针对这一现状,我国翻译理论家谢天振教授提出了著名的译介学理论,紧紧围绕译文中的“创造性叛逆”问题,从文化层面上对翻译尤其是文学翻译进行研究,相关理论已获得学术界的普遍认同。

本文以北宋时期著名的文学家和政治家——“苏轼”的诗词作品为研究对象,选取国内译者许渊冲与国外译者的译文版本进行对比,运用文献法、文本对比法、归纳法,对苏轼词的不同英译本进行对比研究,从内容和形式两方面深刻分析译本中大量存在的创造性叛逆现象,进而探索与之相应的翻译方法,旨在为今后宋词英译研究提供经验和借鉴。

论文第一章介绍苏轼词英译的研究背景、研究方法和研究意义,第二章运用文献法,通过检索中国知网、超星、万方三大国内数据库以及 Springer、SAGE journal、Jstor 三大国外数据库,从国内、国外两方面详细介绍苏轼词英译的研究现状。第三章阐述译介学理论及其核心观点“创造性叛逆”。第四章分别从内容叛逆、形式叛逆两方面探讨苏轼词英译中创造性叛逆现象及其表现形式,并就四字结构翻译、文化负载词翻译、文化意象翻译和无主句翻译具体阐释内容叛逆,从韵律诗和自由诗两种文体分析苏轼词英译中的形式叛逆。第五章运用文本对比法,对比研究国内译者许渊冲和国外译者两种译文版本,从译介学视角解读译者采用的翻译策略,并分析归化、异化策略在苏轼词英译中的具体表现。归化策略表现为省译、增译、意译、意象替

代、句子释译、语序调整等方法。异化策略表现为音译、意象移植、语序一致等方法。第六章对全篇进行总结并反省不足之处。

关键词：译介学；苏轼诗词；创造性叛逆；翻译策略

Abstract

In recent years, under the guidance of “Chinese culture going out” strategy, it is the bounden duty of translators to carry forward the traditional culture through the translation of classical poetry, leading to the wide acceptance in the world. However, due to different and complex historical backgrounds, the misreading and distortion of the classical poetry in the process of “going out” are inevitable. In view of this situation, Chinese professor Xie Tianzhen puts forward the famous Medio-translatology theory, which is a study on literary translation from the cultural level, closely related to the “creative treason” in the translation. The relevant theories have been universally recognized in the academic world.

The author selects some representative works of Su Shi, an outstanding writer and politician of the Northern Song Dynasty, to explore translation strategies from the perspective of Medio-translatology. In the thesis, the writer makes a comparative study on the different English versions of Su Shi’s poems through data studies, text contrast and induction, and analyzes the creative treason of different translators from two aspects of content and form. Then the writer introduces the translation strategies and methods commonly used in English versions of Su Shi’s poems in order to provide references for English translation studies of Song lyrics in the future.

The English versions in this thesis are mainly from the domestic translator Xu Yuanchong and foreign translators. The first chapter briefly introduces research background, research methods and significance of English translation of Su Shi’s poems. The second chapter introduces the research status of English translation of Su Shi’s poems from two aspects of home and abroad with the help of abroad academic search systems like Springer, SAGE journal, Jstor and domestic ones like CNKI, WanFang and

Super Star. The third chapter introduces Medio-translatology and its key theory of “Creative Treason”. The fourth chapter discusses creative treason in English versions of Su Shi’s poems from two aspects: content treason and form treason. Content treason is embodied in translation of four-character structure, culture-loaded words, cultural images and sentences without subject. Form treason is embodied in metrical poetry and free verse. The fifth chapter expounds translation strategies to achieve creative treason under the guidance of Medio-translatology. Domestication strategy is adopted creatively in many ways: omission, addition, free translation, substitution of image, adjustment of word order and paraphrase of sentence. Foreignization strategy embodies itself in transliteration, transplant of image and consistency of word order. The sixth chapter makes a conclusion of this thesis and points out some shortcomings.

Key Words: Medio-Translatology; Su Shi’s Poems; Creative Treason; Translation Strategy

Contents

摘 要.....	i
Abstract.....	iii
Contents.....	v
Chapter One Introduction	1
1.1 Research Background	1
1.2 Research Significance.....	1
1.3 Research Methods.....	2
Chapter Two Literature Review	3
2.1 Su Shi and His Poems.....	3
2.2 Research Status	4
2.2.1 Overseas Research	4
2.2.2 Domestic Research.....	5
Chapter Three Theoretical Foundation.....	7
3.1 Medio-Translatology	7
3.2 Creative Treason.....	8
Chapter Four Creative Treason in English Versions of Su Shi's Poems	10
4.1 Creative Treason on the Content	10
4.1.1 Four-Character Structure	10
4.1.2 Culture-Loaded Words.....	14
4.1.3 Cultural Images	18
4.1.4 Sentences without Subject	21
4.2 Creative Treason on the Form	22
4.2.1 Metrical Poetry.....	23
4.2.2 Free Verse	25
Chapter Five Translation Strategies to Achieve Creative Treason	28
5.1 Domestication.....	28
5.1.1 Omission.....	29
5.1.2 Addition	31
5.1.3 Free Translation	35

5.1.4 Substitution of Image	38
5.1.5 Paraphrase of Sentence	41
5.1.6 Adjustment of Word Order	43
5.2 Foreignization	455
5.2.1 Transliteration	455
5.2.2 Transplant of Image	47
5.2.3 Consistency of Word Order	500
Chapter Six Conclusion	53
References	55
攻读硕士学位期间发表的论文及科研成果	58
Acknowledgements	59

Chapter One Introduction

1.1 Research Background

Translation is the link and bridge of communication between foreign literature and domestic literature. Studies have shown that translation is not just related to the two languages, but involved in collision and communication between cultures. From the unexpected turning points of “Gulliver’s travels” and “Robinson Crusoe” to the big hit of “Han Shan’s poetry” in the United States -----“Han Shan is hailed as an outstanding poet in literature of the United States that he hasn’t got in China for one thousand years ”(Ye, 1977, p.173), we can see it is the translation activities that spread literature masterpieces across the world.

Su Shi is hailed as the greatest poet of the Northern Song Dynasty. His poems vary in themes and written in a vigorous and fluent style, brimming with talent and wisdom. He widens the realm, frees the form and betters the artistic conception of Ci poems. However, the study on the translation of Su Shi’s poems, which originated in the 50 and 60s of the last century, is lagging behind. In many respects, it is still in its infancy, which is obviously detrimental to the inheritance and development of Chinese excellent culture. After communicating with the tutor, the writer intends to make a systematic study on the English versions of Su Shi’s poems from the perspective of Medio-translatology.

1.2 Research Significance

Traditional translation studies are confined to language level, while the study under the guidance of Medio-translatology has entered into the new level—cultural level. It is believed that translation is a kind of “creative treason”, embodied in individual translation, mistranslation, abridgment and adaptation. Besides translation is also a medium-----the most important and characteristic medium of literary and cultural communication among different languages, which has also been

recognized by a large number of scholars. Translators need creative treason to reproduce the original artistic conception in translating Su Shi's poems. However, due to the cultural differences between two languages, cultural misreading and distortion are inevitable.

In this thesis, the author intends to elaborate different translator's creative treason from the perspective of Medio-translatology theory by comparing different English versions of Su Shi's poems. Combined with typical English versions, cultural misreading caused by cultural default is comprehensively analyzed in this thesis, and feasible strategies are put forward for better spreading Chinese culture.

The creative point of this thesis is that it is the first attempt by translators to explore translation strategies of Su Shi's poems based on Xie Tianzhen's theory of Medio-translatology. The writer intends to take it as an independent study object from the perspective of Medio-translatology and try to fill the gap in related field.

1.3 Research Methods

Based on the research methods of case analysis and comparative analysis, the writer selects representative poems of Su Shi to analyze translator's creative treason and translation strategies commonly used through comparisons with different English versions, and elaborates cultural misunderstanding and mistranslation between different countries.

Chapter Two Literature Review

2.1 Su Shi and His Poems

Su Shi, styled Zizhan, also known as “Su Dongpo”, is a famous poet, writer, statesman during Northern Song Dynasty. He was born into a poor intellectual family in Meishan in 1037. Su Shi, as well as his father Su Xun and his younger brother Su Che, are famous men of letters during the Northern Song Dynasty. When Su Shi served for the emperor of Northern Song Dynasty, he aligned with Sima Guang and other officials to resist the New Policy party led by Wang Anshi. Unfortunately, he is exiled for his political opinion and then leads a rough life. However, just for this reason, Su Shi builds a strong character in his following experience, which is showed vividly in his poems. During his exiling days, he travels many places to relax himself. So he is also famous for his travel writings, which contributes to Chinese travel literature as well as detailed information of the contemporary iron industry. His poems show great influence in China, Japan and other areas in Asia. Besides he excels in calligraphy and painting. When it comes to other aspects of Su Shi, he also prefers tasteful food. For example, the famous Hangzhou cuisine Dongpo Pork is named after him.

During the whole life, Su Shi writes about 2,700 poems. His poems emerge as a thunderbolt in the literary circle of his time. He widens the realm, frees the form and betters the artistic conception of Ci poetry. His *Nian Nu Jiao: Chibi Huai Gu* honors as a swan song of Ci poems through the ages, recounts the spectacular scene of the ancient battle field and portrays a shining image of the ancient hero Zhou Yu. Su Shi reflects his optimism and open-mind spirit in most of his poems. And he also develops a style of prose that is marked by ease and simplicity. Free from restriction of forms, his prose writing touches upon a wide range of themes and employs flexible techniques of expression. His writings are as free as

“floating clouds and running water, without a fixed nature, going where proper and stopping where they should”.

2.2 Research Status

2.2.1 Overseas Research

Su Shi's poems are regarded as monumental masterpieces in history of Chinese Classical Poetry. But it is late when translators begin to translate Su Shi's poems. According to *the Dictionary of Chinese Translation* (《中国翻译大辞典》), the first English version of Su Shi's poems was published in *Journal of the R A S* volume 44 in 1853. It is a poem describing a peaceful home translated by Loomis A.W. After then, this poem was published by Loomis during 1867 in his book *Confucius and the Chinese Classics: or, Reading in Chinese Literature*. Other documents about the English versions of Su Shi's poems in nineteenth century were very rare. Since 70s and 80s in the nineteenth Century, only a few of Su Shi's translation works had been published in the *Chinese review (CHNQ)*. In 1898, the famous British Sinologist Giles, H.A. published *Chinese Poetry in English Verse*, including 2 poems of Su Shi (《春宵》 and 《纵笔》).

From 1950s to now, there are twenty translators in the west who have translated Su Shi's poems, with less than 300 poems in which Burton Watson is the most successful one with more than 100 poems. The second one is Kang-i Sun Chang with 59 poems. Besides Rexroth Kenneth, Landau Julie and Mair Victor H. translate more than 20 poems. The others only translate one or several poems. Foreign translators often adopt free verse or prose in form when translating Su Shi's poems. Just like what Zhang Mei (2009) set forth her argument, “Owing to cultural differences, foreign scholars often misread and distort artistic conception and content when they translate Chinese classical poetry. For this reason, what western

readers have read is a kind of modified Chinese poems with foreign flavor”.

According to the data base of JSTOR, Springer, there are few studies about Su Shi's poems abroad. The first one was *Self and Landscape in Su Shih* by Andrew L. Marchin in 1966. This paper introduces Su Shi's poems and his life experience, marking that the western scholar begins to explore Su Shi's poems. In a comprehensive view, westerners mainly interpret Su Shi's poems from three angles of politics, history and literature: Ronald C. Egan (1990) introduced the historical value of Su Shi's poems in *Su Shi's "Notes" as a Historical and Literary Source*. Charles Hartman (1993) revealed powerful influence of Su Shi's poems in the Northern Song Dynasty in *The Inquisition against Su Shih: His Sentence as an Example of Sung Legal Practice*. Alice W. Cheang (1998) introduced Su Shi's life experiences and political ambitions in his poems in *Poetry and Transformation: Su Shi's Mirage*. But in view of low research enthusiasm in foreign countries, the quality of studies on Su Shi's poems is relatively rough. Foreign scholars focus on the external value of Su Shi's poems rather than the value as literature treasure. Just like what Dai Yuxia (2016) said, “There are some obvious features in respect of abroad studies on Su Shi's poems, that is, late starting, fewer works and experts on the grounds that western scholars pay less attention to the translation of Su's poems”.

2.2.2 Domestic Research

Domestic translators of Su Shi's poems are Xu Yuanchong, Zhu Chunshen, Xu Zhongjie, Weng Xianliang, Zhao Yanchun, Lin Yutang, Yang Xianyi etc. Guo Zhengshu (1991) introduced six Su Shi's poems translated by Lin Yutang and analyzed two metrical strategies in translating poems, namely, imitating Chinese poems or imitating English poems. This is the first research paper on the translation of Su Shi's poetry published in domestic core journals. Up to now, many domestic scholars have studied Su Shi's English poems from multiple perspectives, including

perspectives of ecological function, translation aesthetics, hermeneutics, relevance theory, reception aesthetics and deconstruction perspective. Dai Yuxia and Fan Fan (2013) explored English translations of Su Shi's poems from relevance theory. It's believed that translation is an endless creative activity of both "vertical dimension" and "horizontal dimension" in the humanistic space. It mainly discusses how translators interpret and reproduce Su Shi's poems in English versions. Dai Yuxia and Hou Aihua (2016), from the perspective of narrative, explored communication between translators and the original author when translating Su Shi's poems and discussed translation skills in details from two aspects of "narrator discourse" and "character discourse".

Besides, there are some studies on translation methods: Wang Danfeng (2010) made a detailed summary of lexical features in English versions of Su Shi's poems, and probed into the corresponding translation methods from the two aspects of register and rhetorical means. Wang Cunying (2012) believed that translators should firstly pursue to artistic beauty, and then the rhythm beauty, and last the beauty of form when translating Su Shi's poems. It also discussed rhyme, tonal pattern, antithesis and other methods through the comparison of multiple versions. Yu Yanqing (2016) explored feasible translation methods in English versions of Su Shi's poems from essential characteristics of the iconicity principles of poems.

Chapter Three Theoretical Foundation

3.1 Medio-Translatology

Medio-translatology is a study of translation (especially literary translation) from the perspective of comparative literature. Strictly speaking, the study of Medio-translatology is a literary or cultural study rather than a language study. It does not concern the transform between the original language and the target language at language level but the loss, deformation, addition, extension of information during translation. It is of unique value and significance for intercultural communication (Xie, 1999, p.1).

Due to differences in natural environments, life experiences and histories, the same thing has different meanings in different language circles. The origin of these differences is the cultural differences that have been formed among different ethnic groups for a long time. Therefore, language differences reflect cultural differences. Different from traditional translation theories, Medio-translatology theory focuses on different research angle and research purpose. Susan Bassnett (2001) put forward her view, “We must regard translation as an important means of literary communication. And we should explore the common expressions, that is, rewriting, because it could reveal transformation model of the literary system when it receives the foreign works”. And Wang Bin (2003) said, “Translation means creating a new culture”. That’s to say, the study under the guidance of Medio-translatology is no longer conducted from language level, but from cultural level.

Medio-translatology on literature translation is a comparative study on the basis of the original and translated literary works from the perspective of culture. To be more specific, the emphasis of this theory lies in the information loss, transformation and addition in cultural communication. As a cross - cultural subject, Medio-translatology makes up for the

shortcomings in traditional translation studies and has a guiding significance for the spread of Chinese literature, making literary research more scientific and systematic.

3.2 Creative Treason

Creative treason is put forward by the French literary sociologist Robert Escarpit (1961) “Translation is always a creative treason”. The creative treason in literary translation is an important research object of Medio-translatology. Creative treason, from the Medio-translatology perspective, is not a simple study based on the text level but cultural level (Ye,2015). It is universally accepted that creative treason is of special research value because “it distinctively reflects differences between cultures, such as block, collision, misunderstanding, distortion” (Xie, 1992). Besides, the subject of creative treason could be translators, readers and the receiving environment.

Translation acts as a medium of communication between Chinese and foreign cultures. Inevitably, cultural barriers and misreading occur in the process of translation, which requires translators to use creative treason in translation and to communicate with two cultures actively. Babara Godard (1984) put forward his view, “The translators have to represent the deeper cultural connotation in his native language because they face new reader groups who are influenced by different culture and aesthetic system. Hence translation is not a unidirectional creation, but the interpenetration of the two systems. Translators are active participants and also the partners of the author”.

“Translation is a kind of creative treason which is manifested as deletion, addition and free translation in form. As a whole, translation undoubtedly plays an important role in literary communication between different languages. As a medium, translation inevitably leads to information transformation, loss or addition. It is believed that translators can appreciate new literature and culture by translating foreign works and

then they could represent the inspiration in their works. In this process, translation plays a role of a media or a bridge between the two countries” (Liao, 1978, p.103). Thanks to translators’ creative treason, literary translation promotes the understanding, acceptance and interpretation between different cultures. All in all, creative treason from the perspective of Medio-translatology helps us comprehend the translation from a broader background. In the transformation of different languages, there will be mutual understanding, misunderstanding and even cultural distortion. Zhu Yaoxian (2007) set forth his argument, “Translation is an activity of cross-culture and cross-language characteristics regardless of time and space”.

Chapter Four Creative Treason

in English Versions of Su Shi's Poems

Creative treason can be found in numerous English versions of Su Shi's poems. In this chapter, the writer probes into different expressions of translators' creative treason in English versions of Su Shi's poems from two aspects, namely, content treason and form treason. In terms of content treason, different expressions have been analyzed in this chapter from four aspects, namely, translation of four-character structure, culture-loaded words, cultural images and sentences without subject. In terms of form treason, it is manifested in two styles of rendition, namely, metrical poetry and free verse.

4.1 Creative Treason on the Content

4.1.1 Four-Character Structure

As a unique language phenomenon, four-character structure is extremely rich in content with specific form in Chinese. Translators need creative treason to translate such structure in order to spread Chinese culture. Different handling with four-character structure is conducive to the development of translation quality of Su Shi's poems.

Example 1

遥想公瑾当年，小乔初嫁了，雄姿英发。

羽扇纶巾，谈笑间，檣櫓灰飞烟灭。

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

I fancy General Zhou Yu at the height of his success,
with a plume fan in hand, in a silk hood, so brave and bright,
laughing and jesting with his bride so fair,
while enemy ships were destroyed as planed like castles in the air.

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

I remember long ago,
 Kung Ch'in newly married to the beautiful Chiao-siao,
 shining in splendor, a young warrior,
 and the other Chu Ko Liang, in his blue cap,
 waving his horsetail duster,
 smiling and chatting as he burned away the navy of Ts' ao Ts' ao.
 Their ashes were scattered to the four winds.
 They vanished away in smoke.

Su Shi uses three four-character structure in the above paragraph. “雄姿英发”, “羽扇纶巾” and “灰飞烟灭” animatedly portray a shining image of Zhou Yu at the height of his career. “雄姿英发” refers to the description of Zhou Yu's appearance. When it comes to the English version, Xu Yuanchong uses “so brave and bright” to represent the charming image of Zhou Yu. He selects two adjectives and describes Zhou Yu's outstanding talent and charisma. We can infer that Zhou Yu is very handsome with remarkable temperament and braveness through his translation. Kenneth Rexroth's version is “shining in splendor, a young warrior”, which is relatively redundant and rigid. His translation is not in line with the unconstrained style of the original poem, which also reflects the great difficulty when foreigners translate Chinese ancient poems.

“羽扇纶巾” depicts Zhou Yu's dressing. In this poem, Su Shi describes him as a self-possessed figure with elegance and confidence. Xu Yuanchong translates “羽扇纶巾” into “with a plume fan in hand, in a silk hood”. He uses two prepositional phrases to represent General Zhou's image. As we know, “羽扇” refers to the fan made by birds' feather. “Plume fan” faithfully represents the original text. Kenneth Rexroth translates into “in his blue cap, waving his horsetail duster”. He uses a prepositional phrase and a gerund phrase in his translation. “Horsetail duster” is in line with “羽扇” of original poem. Such translation fails to

reappear the calmness and confidence of Zhou Yu when he devises strategies. When it comes to the translation of “纶巾”, “silk hood” is more appropriate than “blue cap”. Firstly, “纶巾” is made of silk or something like silk. Secondly, the hood maybe not blue. Hence “silk hood” virtually conveys the real image of Zhou Yu. Above all, it is feasible to translate “羽扇” and “纶巾” respectively. Translators need creative treason to deal with four-character structure in spreading Chinese culture. Therefore, different handling with four-character structure is conducive to the development of translation quality of Su Shi’s poems.

The whole poem is extremely powerful and magnificent. Su Shi uses “灰飞烟灭” to describe the fiasco of Cao military, thus enhancing momentum. Xu Yuanchong translates “灰飞烟灭” as “castles in the air”, an English proverb. It is consistent with the cultural tradition of western countries and highly caters to the interests of foreign readers. “Castles in the air” virtually refers to insecure buildings or unrealistic thoughts. Xu Yuanchong uses “castles in the air” to portray the predicament of Cao military animatedly. Kenneth Rexroth adopts literal translation which is relatively rigid and ambiguous. Nevertheless, we should affirm the value of foreigners’ versions because mistranslation often shows cultural collision between different countries. Translation is not only a mechanical transformation of two languages, but also the communication between different cultures. Chinese translators have a profound cultural foundation and take a unique advantage in translating ancient Chinese poetry. Therefore, we should face up to mistranslation of foreign translators and use creative treason to introduce the authentic Chinese culture to foreign readers, thus exerting influence on the readership overseas.

Example 2

我欲乘风归去，又恐琼楼玉宇，高处不胜寒。

John A. Turner(1976):

Yes, I would wish to mount the winds and wander there.
At home, but dread those onyx towers and halls of jade.
Set so immeasurably cold and high.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Riding the wind, there I would fly,
Yet I'm afraid the crystalline palace would be.
Too high and cold for me.

“乘风归去” embodies author's wish of being an immortal. Because Su Shi is deeply influenced by Taoism, he adopts a detached attitude towards life. He advocates Health Preservation of the Taoism. His wish of being an immortal is also mentioned in poem of 《前赤壁赋》. John A. Turner translates as “mount the winds and wander there at home”, while Xu Yuanchong translates into “riding the wind, there I would fly”. The two versions respectively have its own merits. “Wander there at home” shows the author's imagination of being an immortal which coincides with the author's detached philosophy towards life. “Fly” animatedly presents the action of being an immortal. In the long history of Chinese mythology, gods all can fly, such as the Goddess ChangE's flying to the moon. Su Shi envisions himself as an immortal residing in illusory land. The two versions both extremely reflect translators' creative treason in accordance with their own capacity for poem appreciation.

“琼楼玉宇” in Chinese refers to grand and splendid buildings which are imaginary. John A. Turner translates into “onyx towers and halls of jade”. We can see he pushes the readers towards the author and boldly introduces the unfamiliar four-character structure into the foreign readers. In this regard, his translation is better for the spreading of Chinese ancient culture. Xu Yuanchong translates into “the crystalline palace”. “The crystalline palace” is originally built in Hyde Park, London. It is hailed as a classic miracle in architecture history that no conventional building could

match it at that time. What's more, the crystalline palace embodies the spirit of British innovation. Above all, the two translation versions extremely brim with translators' creative treason.

4.1.2 Culture-Loaded Words

Due to large differences in religion, region and social tradition between English and Chinese, it seems difficult to achieve complete equivalence in terms of culture-loaded words. Therefore, the introduction of creative treason into translation of culture-loaded words is of great importance for the mutual communication between English and Chinese.

Example 1

牛衣古柳卖黄瓜。

Burton Watson(1966):

Half leaning on the old willow, they peddle yellow melons.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

A straw-cloaked man sells cucumbers 'neath a willow tree.

“牛衣”, from “贫民常衣牛马之衣” in 《汉书·食货志》, means straw rain coat. In ancient poems, poets often use “牛衣” to identify poor people. In this line, Su Shi uses metonymy. “牛衣” refers to the peasant who is selling cucumbers in his rain coat. Xu Yuanchong's translation is “a straw-cloaked man”. Such translation animatedly reproduces the peasant image same as the one in original poem. On the contrary, Burton Watson omits “牛衣”. He uses “they” as the subject of the sentence from which the foreigners could not get close to the authentic Chinese ancient history.

Example 2

使君元是此中人。

Burton Watson(1966):

Your governor, long ago, lived in a place like this.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

I remember I was companion of all these.

In these lines, the author regards himself as a peasant and shows his desire to be back to this field, which implies his tiredness of officials and eagerness to seclusion. After numerous setbacks in political life, he reconciles himself to being a companion of the peasants who reside in countryside. Burton Watson translates “使君” into “your governor”. Actually, his translation keeps faithful towards the original poem because the foreigners could know more about the official carrier of Su Shi. But to some extent, such version stresses the author’s official position and destroys the style of the original poem. Xu Yuanchong translates into “I”. First person is adopted in his version, thus narrowing the distance between author and readers. In a word, different handling of the culture-loaded words has its merit in practice. It is hard to judge which one is better.

Example 3

转朱阁，低绮户，照无眠。

John A. Turner(1976):

Her light round scarlet pavilion 'neath brodered screen,
down streams on me that sleepless lie.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

The moon goes round the mansions red
through gauze-draped windows soft to shed.
Her light upon the sleepless bed.

In these lines, Su Shi describes the scene that the falling moon hangs on the window. “朱阁” and “绮户” are difficult points in translation marked by Chinese culture. “朱阁” refers to the red building which the rich live in, while “绮户” refers to “the ornately carved windows”. John A. Turner translates “朱阁” into “scarlet pavilion” while Xu Yuanchong translates into “red mansions”. In accordance with the original poem, the moon passes “朱阁” and hangs on the window. Looking up the original

text, we should be candid that there are windows on such building. “阁” here should be translated into “mansion(阁楼)” rather than “pavilion(亭子)”. John A. Turner translates “绮户” into “broidered screen (镶着刺绣的屏风)” while Xu Yuanchong translates into “gauze-draped windows (覆着薄纱的窗户)”. John A. Turner knows little about the house structure during the Song dynasty and mistranslates “绮户” as “broidered screen (屏风)”. In light of historical common sense, man of letters who live in the Tang and Song dynasties usually write on bast paper, and the remaining waste paper or oil paper is used to drape windows. Therefore it conforms to the history of the Song Dynasty to translate “绮户” into “gauze-draped windows”.

Example 4

却被黄莺儿无情唤起。

Hans H. Frankel(1976):

Only to be wakened by the orioles' cry.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

But are aroused by orioles' song.

In Chinese poems, “oriole” also calls “Huangli”, whose calling is crisp, full of temperament. Sweet voice of girls could earn the epithet “Yan yu ying yin (燕语莺音)”. “Huangli” often occurs in Chinese poems, such as “隔叶黄鹂空好音” and “两个黄鹂鸣翠柳”. In light of cultural tradition of Chinese, “oriole” represents auspiciousness. Hans H. Frankel translates into “orioles' cry” and distorts Chinese traditional culture. Being saddled with tragic atmosphere, “cry” is inconsistent with the traditional culture of China, leading to information distortion. Such translation exerts misleading influence on foreign readership. In this regard, translators should reconcile author's feelings with readers' expectation. Xu Yuanchong's translation “orioles' song” is more enlightening for he

represents the loneliness of missing woman in sharp contrast to the loveliness of oriole's calling.

Example 5

晓来雨过，遗踪何在。

Hans H. Frankel(1976):

In the morning, after the rain, where are their remains?

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

When dawns the day and rain is o'er, we cannot find their traces.

The two translators considerably vary in translating “晓”. “晓” refers in particular to the daybreak time such as “破晓，拂晓”. It is not inappropriate to translate into “in the morning”. “In the morning” refers to the whole morning, however “晓” exclusively refers to such a short period of time as daybreak or dawn. Thanks to Xu Yuanchong's translation of “dawn”, foreigners could picture the cold scene after the rain at the end of spring in their mind.

Example 6

春色三分，二分尘土，一分流水。

Hans H. Frankel(1976):

Of all the colors of spring,
two thirds become dust,
one third flowing water.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Of spring's three graces,
two have gone with the roadside dust,
and one with waves.

“春色” and “秋色” often occur in Chinese poems, that is, the scenery of spring or autumn, which are very familiar to China translators. Hans H. Frankel translates into “colors of spring”. Such literal translation is not in line with the original poem and also causes confusion of readership: how

does “color” change into “dust” and fly into the water? So it is a mistranslation. Xu Yuanchong translates into “spring’s graces”, which is more appropriate. Translators, differing each other in country, social experience and nationality, vary in translating in accordance with their understanding of the original poems. Such disagreements delicately spark the inspiration. In the conversion of different languages, misreading also reflects creative treason and its study is conducive to the exchange and integration of different cultures.

4.1.3 Cultural Images

Cultural images are derived from human’s life experience and social tradition. Non-equivalence of cultural images affects the intercultural communication. In this respect, reconstruction of cultural images reflects mutual absorption and integration between different cultures.

Example 1

恰似姮娥怜双燕，分明照、画梁斜。

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

Maybe Chang-O the moon goddess will pity this single swallow
and join us together with the cord of light
that reaches beneath the painted eaves of your home.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

The Moon Goddess seems to care for the swallows in pair.
She sheds her light into their dream on painted beam.

This is the writer’s imagination. In this poem, the author thinks that the goddess of the moon is exclusively fond of the couple swallows, regardless of the singular person. By sharp comparison of the double swallows with the lonely man, it has a strong artistic appeal and deeply impresses itself on Chinese readership. Kenneth Rexroth translates “双燕” into “single swallow” and fails to convey the author’s feelings, thus causing information loss and distortion of the original poem. With a better

understanding of the original poem, Xu Yuanchong translates into “the swallows in pair”. “In pair” also means “in couples”. Such translation animatedly shows the comparison of the lover swallows with the author’s bitter feelings and better represents the deeper cultural connotation in this poem.

When it comes to “姮娥”, the two translators adopt different translation methods. Kenneth Rexroth translates into “Chang-O the moon goddess”. He uses transliteration and annotation, which is conducive to the spread of Chinese culture. “Chang-O” is transliteration, which is to the benefit of the spread of Chinese poems. “The moon goddess” is annotation, which reduces the cultural strangeness and reading barriers when the foreigners read this poem. While Xu Yuanchong translates into “the Moon Goddess”. He adopts annotation which is beneficial to the reading habits of the foreigners. But such version fails to represent the typical Chinese cultural images. In other words, his translation does not introduce Chinese cultural images to the foreigners, thus not leading to the wide acceptance of Chinese culture in the world. Above all, when it comes to the spread of Chinese culture, the translation of Kenneth Rexroth should be more advocated.

Example 2

明月几时有？把酒问青天。

John A. Turner(1976):

When did this glorious moon begin to be?

Cup in hand, I ask of the azure sky.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

How long will the full moon appear?

Wine cup in hand, I ask the sky.

“明月” and “青天” are very common images in ancient Chinese poems such as “欲上青天揽明月” “断肠青天望明月” and so forth. Moon

is an image frequently used by Chinese poets to express private feelings. “The moon is a basket or a carrier of emotions, loading all kinds of feelings of the poets” (Pan, 1991, p. 209). The waxing and waning of the moon are used to symbolize both the union and separation of families, through the depiction of which he expresses his deep love for his brother and for life. And it is just on the mid-autumn festival when Su Shi writes this poem. Seeing the full moon, a symbol of family reunion, Su Shi is yearning for his brother Su Zhe, whom he has not seen for seven years. Based on this, “明月” should be translated as “the full moon”. John A. Turner’s translation “glorious moon” is literal translation. He fails to understand the ancient poets’ extremely sensitive feelings towards the moon, thus leading to information loss and distortion in translation. While Xu Yuanchong translates into “the full moon”, which is more appropriate under such circumstance. The word of “full” means that the moon appears as a complete circle with the meaning of completeness and happiness. For this reason, “the full moon” is more in line with the best wishes of ancient Chinese people.

Besides “明月”, the two translators also vary in translating “青天”. Whether to translate “青” or not, we should go back to the original poem. Based on the common sense, it is at night when people get together and enjoy the beauty of moon. At that time, the sky is dark rather than azure. For this reason, it is not appropriate to translate “青天” into “the azure sky”. John A. Turner’s translation could not truly represent the real scene in the original poem. To be more specific, his translation runs in the opposite direction with our common sense. There are many reasons leading to mistranslation of foreign translators, for example, the lack of sufficient understanding of cultural background of the original text. Xu Yuanchong uses omission translation and translates into “sky”, which is in line with

the original poem. Under such circumstance, “sky” is more appropriate rather than “azure sky”.

4.1.4 Sentences without Subject

Sentence without subject is a typical sentence pattern in Chinese. Transformation of such sentence into English raises a challenge to translators, brimming with their creativity and wits.

Example 1

不应有恨，何事长向别时圆。

John A. Turner(1976):

Ah, vain indeed is my complaining,
but why must she beam at the full on those that sundered sigh?

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Against man she should have no spite.
Why, then, when people part, is she oft full and bright?

Apparently, John A. Turner thinks the subject of “不应有恨” is the author. In fact, the subject is the moon. In John A. Turner’s version, Su Shi complain about the moon, which is a deviation from original poem. Xu Yuanchong’s translation is more conducive to the reading of foreigners and is more in line with the original poem.

Example 2

故国神游，多情应笑我，早生华发。

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

I like to dream of those dead kingdoms.
Let people laugh at my prematurely gray hair.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Should their souls revisit this land,
sentimental, his bride would laugh to say:
Younger than they, I have my hair turned gray.

In the original poem, the subject of “故国神游” is not clear. In Xu Yuanchong’s version, he declares that souls of ancient heroes visit here again and Xiao Qiao plays the role of laughing at the author. Such arrangement could make the translation more logical and fluent. Xu Yuanchong’s translation seems to deviate from the original poem, however it virtually reaches the same goal as the original text. Xu Yuanchong skillfully uses creative treason and adds the subject of the sentence, thus making sentence structure more clear. In short, Kenneth Rexroth’s translation gets closer to the original poem exclusively in form, however Xu Yuanchong’s translation better reappears the connotation and artistic conception of the original poem.

4.2 Creative Treason on the Form

George Steiner (1975) declared “translation is endless in theory.” Due to different cultures of countries, translators creatively translate poems in different ways, not only in content, but also in form.” Theodore Horace Savory (1957) put forward his argument, “poems must be translated into free verse. And poems must be translated into poems.” It remains controversial whether or not to translate poem into poem. According to study, there are three schools in domain of Chinese poems translating, that is, School of Metrical poetry, School of Free verse and School of Rewriting. In this thesis, the writer divides the translators specialized in translating Su Shi’s poems into the previous two groups.

“Translation is not only a cross-language behavior but also a cross-culture behavior with historic significance” (Wei, 2017. p8). Chinese prefer to use metrical poetry when they translate Chinese classical poems, while the foreign scholars prefer free verse.

The word of metrics is derived from the classical Chinese poetry with certain specifications in sentence pattern and phonology. Free verse is different from metrical poetry. It is difficult to use rhyme in English because translators have to make a big change on the basis of the original

poem, such as adding some words or paraphrasing the sentences. Metrical poetry stresses the rhyme, rhythm and tone. Free verse is marked by spirit expressing without fixed structure. Free verse is a very common form of modern poetry. It refers to the poem with lines differing in length. For example, American poet Whitman uses this form in his book *Leaves of Grass*.

4.2.1 Metrical Poetry

James McAuley (1966) declared, “poem is an art of form in which phrases are dancing”. Liu Junping (1996) set forth his argument, “the information of poems is conveyed by the combination of content and form. In the meanwhile, poem forms (such as rhyme and rhythm) are more expressive than its contents”. When translating Su Shi’s poems, Chinese translators pay more attention to the beauty of sound and form in their versions. Xu Yuanchong is a typical poet specialized in translating Su Shi’s poems with metrical poetry form. He stresses the beauty of form and the expressiveness of content. For this reason, he pays more attention to the rhyme in his translation.

Example 1

Xu Yuanchong(2015):

For ten long years the living of the dead knows nought.

Though to my mind not brought,

Could the dead be forgot?

Her lonely grave is far, a thousand miles away.

To whom can I my grief convey?

Revived, e’en if she be,

Oh, could she still know me?

My face is worn with care

And frosted is my hair.

Last night I dreamed of coming to our native place;

she’s making up her face

Before her mirror with grace.
Each saw the other hushed,
But from our eyes tears gushed.
When I am woken, oh, I know I'll be heart-broken
Each night when the moon shines
O'er her grave clad with pines.

Wang Dongfeng (2018) put forward his argument, “poetic flavor is more endowed by its form”. Xu Yuanchong uses end rhyme in his translated text. As we can see, “nought, brought, forgot”, “away, convey” respectively share the same end syllable. Similarly, “be, me”, “care, hair”, “place, face, grace”, “hushed, gushed”, “shines, pines” respectively share the same end syllable. We call such figure of speech as the end rhyme. Such translation adds the beauty of rhythm and the beauty of structure to the poetry. Paul Jr. Fussel (1965) put forward his argument, “meter is indispensable in expressing poetic meaning”. Wen Yiduo (1993) declared, “the reason why poems could inspire our feelings lies in its rhythm, that is, metrics”. Frankly speaking, it is difficult for translators to translate poems in metrical style owing to differences between the two cultures. Translators need profound culture background and translation skills to use rhyme when conveying the original information faithfully.

Example 2

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

The moon goes round the mansions red
Through gauze-draped windows soft to shed.
Her light upon the sleepless bed.
Against man she should have no spite.
Why then when people part, is she oft full and bright?
Men have sorrow and joy; they part or meet again;
The moon is bright or dim and she may wax or wane.
There has been nothing perfect since the olden days.

So let us wish that man
Will live long as he can!

Though miles apart, we'll share the beauty she displays.

Xu Yuanchong also adopts alliteration in his translation. Alliteration refers to repetition of the same letter in English poems. That's to say, in a group of words, a sentence or a line of poetry, the initial syllables share the same letter or voice in two or more than two words that are close to each other, especially the consonant letters. Alliteration can enhance the rhythm and rhyme of poems, full of expressiveness and music sense. In the above translated text, the beginning syllables of "moon, mansions" are consonant letter "m" and "m" is not silent. Hence it is alliteration. The beginning syllables of "soft" and "shed" in "soft to shed" are consonant letter "s". Hence it is alliteration. Similarly, "why then when" "wax or wane" are alliteration, too. The appropriate application of alliteration makes translation more harmonious and symmetrical. Todorov (1981) said, "What others regard as form can be the subject matter in my eyes."

"When translating Su Shi's poems, translators should reproduce the deep meaning of the original poems, and then pursue the beauty on form (Yan, 2005)." In addition to the selected examples, Xu Yuanchong also uses a lot of alliteration and end rhyme, we do not take more examples.

4.2.2 Free Verse

Lin Yutang declared in his book *On Translating Poems* "we can use rhyme to translate poems, but generally it is inappropriate to use rhyme" (Lin, 2007, p.70). Julie Landau (1997) also put forward his argument, "if Song poem is translated in the form of metrical English poetry, it would be extremely obsolete and difficult to restore the colloquial characteristics of Song poem". Different from Chinese translators, foreigners prefer to use free verse, which is on the grounds of differences in cultures. Generally speaking, westerners are more romantic and straightforward than Chinese, which can also be verified in their poems. Free verse can also show the

spirits of Chinese ancient poems. Such poems pay attention to the images and feelings in poetry rather than rhyme and rhythm. In a word, free verse is marked by three main features: no rhyme, regardless of foot, difference in length.

Example 1

John A. Turner(1976):

When did this glorious moon begin to be?
Cup in hand, I ask of the azure sky:
And wondered in the palaces of the air
What calendar this night do they go by.
Yes, I would wish to mount the winds and wander there
At home, but dread those onyx towers and halls of jade
Set so immeasurably cold and high.

From the above example, we can see that, the foreign translator John A. Turner uses free verse in his translation. He does not use any metrical structure, no matter end rhyme or alliteration. The translator focuses on expressing his understanding and feelings rather than the form. Free verse fully reflects the characteristics of the westerners and caters to their reading habits. In this respect, translating Chinese poems with free verse form could spur foreigners' reading interests and promote cultural communication.

Example 2

Hans H. Frankel(1976):

In dreams they follow the wind a thousand miles,
Seeking the place their lover went,
Only to be awakened by the orioles' cry.
I don't regret that these blossoms have all flown away,
I regret that in the West garden the fallen red petals are hard to gather.
In the morning, after the rain, where are their remains?

We can see, Hans H. Frankel also uses free verse in his translation. The lines are of different lengths in the above example. In short, the number of words in different sentences are different. And the translator does not use metrics at all. In this way, we can conclude that the foreigners emphasize on the content rather than the form.

Chapter Five Translation Strategies

to Achieve Creative Treason

Under the guidance of Medio-translatology theory, translators interpret Su Shi's poems in many creative ways which can be classified into two strategies, namely, domestication and foreignization. Translation strategies to achieve creative treason are discussed in this chapter. Domestication is creatively employed in Su Shi's poems, such as omission, addition, free translation, substitution of image, adjustment of word order, paraphrase of sentence and free verse in form. Foreignization manifests itself in transliteration, transplant of image, consistency of word order and metrical poetry in form. Above all, flexible utilization of translation methods brims with translators' creative treason.

5.1 Domestication

“Cultural default remains a difficulty in translation owing to the differences between Chinese and English. Under such circumstances, it depends on translators' creative treason to adopt which strategy (Nida, 2001).” There are numerous translation methods in translating Su Shi's poems. From the perspective of Medio-translatology, all these methods could be classified into two groups, namely, foreignization and domestication.

Venuti (1995) said “domestication pushes the author towards the readers.” Domestication allows translators to cater to the mainstream values of the target country and to adopt a transparent and fluent style to minimize the strangeness of the original. Domestication is discussed in this chapter, such as omission, addition, free translation, substitution of image, adjustment of word order, paraphrase of sentence.

5.1.1 Omission

In translation, in order to achieve the same artistic effect as the original, or to reduce the cultural strangeness, sophisticated translators will make good use of the omission methods. Here are some examples.

Example 1

日暖桑麻光似泼，风来蒿艾气如薰。使君元是此中人。

Burton Watson (1966):

Sun warm on mulberry and hemp glints like water;

Wind over mugwort and moxa comes perfumed.

Your governor, long ago, lived in a place like this.

Xu Yuanchong (1982):

Hemp and mulberry glint as if steeped in sunshine;

Mugwort and moxa spread a sweet scent in the breeze.

I remember I was companion of all these.

As we know, Su Shi suffers continuous frustrations in his political life and writes numerous poems to express his attitude towards life and his political career. In the above lines, Su Shi shows his intention of returning to the countryside, which implies his tiredness of official circles and eagerness to seclude. Burton Watson translates into “your governor, long ago, lived in a place like this”, which inappropriately stresses Su Shi’s official post and destroys the style of the original poem. What’s more, this version does not convey the author’s desire to seclude thus leading to information distortion. As for Su Shi, countryside is a paradise without partisan strife. Hence it is reasonable for him to think of seclusion. Xu Yuanchong uses omission and translates into “I remember I was companion of all these”. The word of “companion” brings the author and the villagers closer. Xu Yuanchong does not illuminate Su Shi’s official position “使君”, which conforms to the style of the source text.

Example 2

去年相送，余杭门外，飞雪似杨花。

Kenneth Rexroth (1971):

Last year when I accompanied you
As far as the Yang Chou Gate,
The snow as flying, like white willow cotton.

Xu Yuanchong (1982):

Last year we bade adieu
Outside the town;
Snow flew like willow down.

“余杭门外” indicates the place where Su Shi tears himself away from his wife. There are many proper nouns in Chinese, such as personal name and place name. When it comes to the translation of place name, translators should adopt feasible translation methods on the premise of faithfulness and expressiveness. To be specific, in order to lower the strangeness between the two cultures, it is necessary to take into account the omission method. Kenneth Rexroth translates into “Yang Chou Gate”, which is not appropriate. Firstly, “Yuhang” is Hangzhou during Northern Song Dynasty, not “Yang Chou”. Secondly, foreign readers know little about Chinese ancient culture. This version increases the confusion of readers: where is the “Yang Chou Gate” and what’s the function of this “gate”? By contrast, Xu Yuanchong makes full use of the omission and translates into “outside the town”. He omits the place name of “Yuhang”. On the one hand, place name can help Chinese readers understand the poem easily owing to their background of geography. On the other hand, foreigners are unfamiliar with the place names of China, which increases the difficulty of foreigners’ reading. Given to this, it is a feasible way to omit place names especially those without special implication. Xu Yuanchong’s translation of “outside the town” not only preserves the original information, but also avoids the cultural barriers, which brims with translator’s creative treason.

Example 3

明月几时有？把酒问青天。

John A. Turner(1976):

When did this glorious moon begin to be?

Cup in hand, I ask of the azure sky.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

How long will the full moon appear?

Wine cup in hand, I ask the sky.

Looking up in this poem, it is at night when family enjoy the beauty of moon together. Apparently, “青天” should not be translated into “the azure sky”. Such translation results in foreigners’ confusion: “how to enjoy the beauty of the moon in the azure sky”. By contrast, Xu Yuanchong makes full use of the omission method and delete the word “青”. This version of “sky” relatively matches the reality.

5.1.2 Addition

Addition means adding some words, phrases or sentences to express the meaning contained in the original text more accurately owing to different ways of thinking and language habits between English and Chinese. It is mainly used in Chinese-English translation. “In Chinese, some sentence constituents could be left out, such as subject and object” (Ye, 1997, p.115). “Usually, there are no subjects in Chinese poems, by which readers get more space for imagination” (Huang, 2013). There are some sentences without subject in Chinese but few in English. When translating this kind of sentence, we usually adopt addition in order to ensure the integrity of the grammatical structure of the translation. The following examples are given.

Example 1

萦损柔肠，困酣娇眼，欲开还闭。

Hans H. Frankel(1976):

Their tender hearts are knotted and hurt,
Their lovely eyes are tired and drunk,
Wanting to open but staying closed.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Their grief-o'er laden bowels tender like willow branches slender.
Their wistful eyes, like willow leaves,
Near shut with sleep, about to open, yet soon closed again.

Su Shi uses the metaphor by comparing willow as the missing woman. He personalizes the willow in order to describe the image of a married woman who is missing her husband. Hans H. Frankel's translation is inconsistent with the style of the original poem for he fails to capture the spirits of the original poem. Su Shi uses “萦损柔肠” to show the woman's sadness and her missing. However Hans H. Frankel's translation is “their tender hearts are knotted and hurt”, which is too straightforward. The poem itself is very condensed. Such translation is too simple without displaying the charm of the poem. Thus the foreign readers cannot have a deep understanding about the poem. Xu Yuanchong uses addition translation and adds “like willow branches slender” and “like willow leaves” in his translation. He captures the key word “grief” and stresses the heroine's missing. And he also compares “柔肠” as “slender willow branches”, which is a very novel analogy for the foreigners. Because “柳条” and “柳叶” represent “愁思” “愁绪” in Chinese culture. Given to this, such translation helps the foreigners have a vivid understanding of the image of the missing woman. Xu Yuanchong introduces new images in Chinese poems to the foreigners and displays the charm and characteristics of Chinese poems, which is conducive to culture exchanges.

Example 2

不应有恨，何事长向别时圆。

John A. Turner(1976):

Ah, vain indeed is my complaining,
But why must she beam at the full on those that sundered sigh?

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Against man she should have no spite.
Why, then, when people part, is she oft full and bright?

“不应有恨，何事长向别时圆” means: the moon should not have any resentment for people. Why is it always full and bright when people leave apart? Apparently, John A. Turner makes an error in translating the first sentence. He thinks that the subject of “不应有恨” is Su Shi, which is obviously wrong. In fact, the subject is the moon. John A. Turner mistranslates into “I complained in vain”. Therefore, there is a deviation from the original poem. Xu Yuanchong grasps the poem correctly. With clear logic, such translation is more conducive to the reading of foreigners and is more in line with the original poem. In addition to this, the two translators both adopt addition methods in translating the poem. Generally, there are many sentences without subjects in Chinese, which are not very common in English. Hence the two translators adopt addition methods to cater to the reading habits of the foreign readers, which brims with their creative treason.

Example 3

细看来，不是杨花，点点是离人泪。

Hans H. Frankel(1976):

When you look closely, they are not willow catkins,
Dot after dot, but tears of separated people.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

But if you just take a close look,
Then you will never find willow down but tears of those who sever,
Which drop by drop fall without stop.

From the three sentences, Su Shi associates the catkins with the tears of the woman, that is to say, he associates the real things with the abstract things. Tai Wan poet Yu Guangzhong (2003) said, “poets express their feelings by describing the real things and then readers restore the feelings of the author from the description of the real things. That is image.” Therefore “点点” modifies “离人泪” instead of the catkins. Su Shi associates the falling catkins with the tears of the apart people in the original poem. Xu Yuanchong uses addition methods and adds “never find willow down” and “fall without stop” by which the readers could understand clearly that the leading role is the woman rather than the catkins. Such version vividly reproduces the resentment and helplessness of the woman because her husband has been away from her for a long time. It pushes the author’s feeling to a new height and fully shows the sadness of the woman. Hans H. Frankel translates “点点” into “dot after dot” literally and wrongly believes that “点点” modifies the catkins. It can be seen that the foreign translators are unfamiliar with such figure of speech in ancient Chinese poems. Chinese poets prefer to be more implicit than the foreigners and they usually use obscure words to express their feelings, which causes difficulties for foreigners to translate.

Example 4

故国神游，多情应笑我，早生华发。

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

I like to dream of those dead kingdoms.

Let people laugh at my prematurely gray hair.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Should their souls revisit this land, sentimental,

His bride would laugh to say:

Younger than they, I have my hair turned gray.

As we know, there are many sentences without subject in Chinese due to different linguistic habits. Both translators adopt addition in translation to ensure the integrity of grammatical structure. Kenneth Rexroth adds “I” and “people” as the subject in his translation while Xu Yuanchong adds “their souls” and “his bride”, both of which show the creative treason of the translators. Xu Yuanchong thinks that the souls of the ancient heroes visit the countries again. Besides he regards it is Xiao Qiao that plays the role of laughing at Su Shi.

5.1.3 Free Translation

Free translation is a supplementary means mainly to convey the meaning or the spirit of the original poems without trying to reproduce the sentence patterns or figures of speech. Free translation is mainly applied under such circumstances when there are great cultural differences between the source language and the target language. Free translation to some extent reflects differences between cultures, such as ecological culture, language culture, religious culture, material culture and social culture. Xu Yuanchong (1984) declared, “in terms of free translation, translators must put the faithfulness towards original text in the first place. And the second one is fluency of his translated text.”

Xu Yuanchong uses lots of free translation in translating Su Shi’s poems. Here are some examples sparkling his creative treason.

Example 1

大江东去，浪淘尽，千古风流人物。

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

Its waves have washed away all the heroes of history.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

The endless river eastward flows;

With its huge waves are gone

all those gallant heroes of bygone years.

In original poem, Su Shi extols the magnificence of the mighty long river and the braveness of the heroes who lived in the past. Obviously, the river does not “wash away” the gallant heroes. Those heroes are gone with the passing time. Nevertheless, Kenneth Rexroth translates “淘尽” to “wash away”, which fails to reproduce the original poem. In Xu Yuanchong’s version, both “gallant heroes” and “huge waves” are “gone”. He chooses free translation rather than literal translation. Not missing the mark, he manages to revitalize the original content.

Example 2

纵使相逢应不识，尘满面，鬓如霜。

Xu Yuanchong (1982) :

Revived, e’en if she be, oh, could she still know me?

My face is worn with care.

And frosted is my hair.

Burton Watson (1966) :

Even if we met you wouldn’t know me,

Dust on my face,

Hair like frost-

Here “尘满面” represents the author’s gaunt face after sufferings in his life. Adopting literal translation, Burton Watson translates into “dust on his face” which fails to reproduce deeper connotation in original poem. Chinese poems cannot be translated literally as a whole. “Translators should have a better understanding of the author’s life experience and his work styles” (Zhang, 2014). Medio-Translatology theory requires translators to adopt feasible translation strategies to show their creative treason and then help the foreigners who lack of original text background understand the poems. Xu Yuanchong translates as “my face is worn with care”. He uses free translation and better reproduces the deeper connotation in original poem. Such translation sparkles translator’s

creative treason and better represents the author's inner torments and bitter sufferings after his wife died. His version manages to make target readers' response the same as source-text readers'. As a whole, literal translation sometimes fails to reproduce the original poem. At such circumstances, free translation should be taken into account.

Example 3

梦随风万里，寻郎去处，又还被、莺呼起。

Xu Yuanchong (1982) :

They dream of drifting with the wind for long,
Long miles to find their men,
but are aroused by orioles' song.

Hans H. Frankel (1976) :

In dreams they follow the wind a thousand miles,
Seeking the place their lover went,
Only to be awakened by the orioles' cry.

Generally speaking, the figures in classical poems do not refer to concrete numbers (Xia, 1998, p.124-128). Chinese poets prefer to use numbers in poems, such as “七八个星天外，两三点雨山前”，“飞流直下三千尺，疑是银河落九天” and “三人行，必有我师”. in the above example, “万里”, being not an exact figure, means that the distance is far away. In this respect, translators should adopt free translation instead of literal translation. Hans H. Frankel translates into “a thousand miles”. Due to the differences between Chinese and English, the foreign translator fails to fully master the expressive technique in ancient Chinese poems. Such translation does conform to the original text. Xu Yuanchong's translation “long, long miles” is more enlightening for his translation helps readers have a better understanding of the original text and the writing characteristics of Chinese ancient poetry.

5.1.4 Substitution of Image

Same image is often endowed with different cultural connotation in different nations or countries. When translating, translators often substitute the original image with another image in the targeted language which shares the same meaning with the original image. For example, “dragon” is traditional image in China, which can be regarded as the symbol of power and wealth. But in western counties, dragon signifies fierce ghost. In this respect, “亚洲四小龙” is translated into “four Asian tigers”. Xu Yuanchong (1991) set forth his argument, “translators could creatively use some translation methods based on the original text.” Therefore, creative employment of substitution brims with translators’ creative treason.

Example 1

故垒西边，人道是，三国周郎赤壁。

Kenneth Rexroth (1971) :

To the West of the ancient
Wall you enter the Red Gorge
Of Chu Ko Liang of the
Days of the Three Kingdoms.

Xu Yuanchong (1982) :

West of the ancient fortress appears
Red Cliff where General Zhou won his early fame
When the Three Kingdoms were in flame.

This poem is written when Su Shi visits the Red Cliff in Huangzhou where he is degraded to be a local official. In this poem, Su Shi describes the scenery of the Red Cliff and extols General Zhou who lives during the Three Kingdoms. The foreigners are unfamiliar with the cultural background related with Red Cliff. In order to help the foreigners lacking of Chinese culture better understand the original poem, translators have to use his creative treason and think over the wording to reproduce the source

text. As for the two different translated versions, Xu Yuanchong points out the historical significance of “Red Cliff” in his version “west of the ancient fortress appears Red Cliff”. By contrast, Kenneth Rexroth translates into “the West of the ancient Wall” without any introduction or explanation about the cultural background of “Red Cliff”. Su Shi expresses his broad-minded attitude towards life and history by describing the scene at Red Cliff and the life story of Zhou Yu. Given to this, translator should introduce the historical background of Red Cliff. “Translators should fully take into consideration horizon of expectations of the targeted readers (Dai, 2011, p106)”. Above all, Xu Yuanchong’s translation matches the original poem. He finds out the equivalent substitution of “垒” in English and manages to reproduce the cultural implication behind Red Cliff. He introduces the background of the story, that is, the ancient battlefield, laying groundwork for the following description of ChiBi battle.

Example 2

酒困路长惟欲睡，日高人渴漫思茶。敲门试问野人家。

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Wine-drowsy when the road is long, I yearn for bed;
Throat parched when the sun is high, I long for tea.
I knock at farmer’s door to see to what he’ll treat me.

Burton Watson(1966):

Wine-drowsy, a long road, I’m getting sleeping;
Sun high, throat parched, thinking only of tea-
I’ll knock on a gate and see what the villagers’ ll give me.

“Poems translation not only refers to the transformation of language but also the image transformation” (Yuan, 2012). “野人” in the source text means the peasants who reside in rural areas. Most of them depend on agriculture or animal husbandry for their livelihood. Frankly speaking, they are self-sufficient and relatively poor. Xu Yuanchong uses “farmer”,

which is not relatively equivalent. Because in western countries, farmers are the owners of great landed estates specializing in agriculture. The forced recruitment of local laborers allowed by colonial law makes these lands particularly lucrative for their owners. So the farmers in western countries are usually particularly rich and affluent. “Farmer” is not the equivalent substitution of “野人”. On the other hand, Burton Watson translates into “villagers”. Such translation represents Burton Watson’s creative treason and profound foundation of literature.

Example 3

小轩窗，正梳妆。

Burton Watson(1966):

By the window of the little room,
you were combing your hair and making up.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

She’s making up her face,
before her mirror with grace.

Burton Watson (1966) said, “people during Song Dynasty resemble modern Europeans more than our ancients in terms of lifestyle, value and interest,” which spurs him to translate numerous literary works of Song Dynasty. The two translators vary each other in translating “正梳妆”. “梳妆” refers to making-up in ancient days. Obviously, Burton Watson misunderstands “梳妆” as “combing hair and making up”. Xu Yuanchong translates into “making up her face”, which is basically consistent with the original poem. Rather than the foreign translators, Chinese translators have no cultural estrangement in translating ancient poems of China, so they can make clear the connotations in the ancient poems and pick up the equivalent image in target language. Nevertheless, we should also affirm the value of foreigners’ mistranslation which sheds light on the causes of collision, distortion and transformation between different cultures.

Mistranslation sometimes reflects the translator's misunderstanding of another culture, thus being of extraordinary research value.

5.1.5 Paraphrase of Sentence

It is a consensus among western translation theorists that “translation is interpretation”. Actually from ancient times, Chinese translation theorists have clearly stated about the relationship between translation and interpretation. Paraphrase refers to interpretative translation. That's to say, paraphrase is adopted to reproduce information of original poem without preservation of the same syntactic structure as the original.

Example 1

起舞弄清影，何似在人间。

John A. Turner(1976):

To tread a measure, to sport with fleshless shade,
How alien to our frail mortality!

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

I rise and dance; with my shadow I play.
On high as on earth, would it be as gay?

The lines are Su Shi's praise towards the human world. Apparently, John A. Turner wrongly believes that such sentence is Su Shi's yearning and praise to the heavenly life, which basically runs in opposite directions with the idea of Su Shi. That is to say, this sentence actually shows Su Shi's praise and devotion to the real world. We can see that there is a great loss of information and distortion between John A. Turner's translation and the original poem. His translation fails to reproduce the ups and downs of the author's emotions. On the other hand, Xu Yuanchong translates accurately and reproduces the ups and downs of the author's emotions successfully with a better grasp of Su Shi's thoughts and feelings. He uses paraphrase translation and shows his creative treason.

Example 2

抛家傍路，思量却是，无情有思。

Hans H. Frankel(1976):

They leave home and drop by the roadside.

Examine them and you find they lack feeling but have longing.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Forsaking leafy home, by the roadside they roam.

I think they're fickle but they've sorrow deep.

Wang Shunshun (2010) said, "Catkins, being of tremendous artistic appeal, are loaded with deep feelings". "抛家" means "leaving the branch". That is, catkins fall off from the tree. It seems that the catkins are heartless but actually it is affectionate. Su Shi implies his situation by chanting catkins. Hans H. Frankel translates into "they lack feeling but have longing". "His translated text is less expressive than original poem because he fails to represent the deep cultural connotations between catkins and Su Shi's plight" (Dai, 2016). He thinks the catkins are "heartless", which apparently is wrong. Not having a deep understanding of the author's thoughts and feelings, he deviates from original poem. Such translation confuses the foreign readers and causes the reading barriers. Xu Yuanchong paraphrases the line, "I think they're fickle but they've sorrow deep." With the first person in his poem, he shortens the distance between readers and author. In this way, his translation completely conveys the author's feelings and paves the way for following paragraph. This example shows that creative treason is not the translator's unconstrained rewriting, but the flexible translating methods based on the original poem which is better for cultural communication between the two countries. Flexible shifts of person perspective could narrow the distance between author and readers, thus helping readers have a better understanding of the original spirit.

5.1.6 Adjustment of Word Order

Example 1

遥想公瑾当年，小乔初嫁了，雄姿英发。

羽扇纶巾，谈笑间，檣櫓灰飞烟灭。

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

I fancy General Zhou Yu at the height of his success,
with a plume fan in hand, in a silk hood, so brave and bright,
laughing and jesting with his bride so fair,
while enemy ships were destroyed as planed like castles in the air.

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

I remember long ago,
Kung Ch'in newly married to the beautiful Chiao-siao,
shining in splendor, a young warrior,
and the other Chu Ko Liang, in his blue cap,
waving his horsetail duster,
smiling and chatting as he burned away the navy of Ts' ao Ts' ao.
Their ashes were scattered to the four winds.
They vanished away in smoke.

These lines show Zhou Yu's power and prestige with a beauty beside him. Su Shi focuses on the description of Zhou Yu's appearance. Xu Yuanchong makes a big change in word order when translating. To be more specific, Xu Yuanchong uses four kinds of concomitant adverbials in his translation, that is, "with a plume fan in hand", "in a silk hood", "so brave and bright" and "laughing and jesting with his bride so fair". His translation is well arranged with logic. He reverses the position of "雄姿英发" and "羽扇纶巾", which makes the translated version more logical. Domestication strategy has been successfully applied in Xu Yuanchong's translation in order to cater to the reading habits of the foreign language readers and reduce the cultural strangeness. In a general view, Xu

Yuanchong shows his creative treason in his translation and reproduces the original poem fluently. On the contrary, Kenneth Rexroth's translation is relatively rigid controlled by his limited Chinese background, which also reflects the great difficulty when foreigners translate Chinese ancient poems. Besides Kenneth Rexroth makes a mistake in his translation. The subject of “羽扇纶巾” should be Zhou Yu rather than Chu Ko Liang. Of course, we cannot completely deny the value of the foreigners' translation. Chinese translators have a profound cultural foundation and a unique advantage in translating the ancient Chinese poetry. But mistranslations of foreign translators often show cultural collision between the two countries, which we should pay more attention to in the later translation.

Example 2

日暖桑麻光似泼，风来蒿艾气如薰。

Burton Watson(1966):

Sun warm on mulberry and hemp glints like water;

Wind over mugwort and moxa comes perfumed.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Hemp and mulberry glint as if steeped in sunshine.

Mugwort and moxa spread a sweet scent in the breeze.

“光似泼” gives full expression to the flourish scene of the countryside. It can be seen that Burton Watson prefers to use literal translation, that is, word-for-word translation. His translation fails to reproduce the image of the original poem controlled by the poem form. Hence the foreigner readers cannot picture in their mind the flourishing scenery of the field in the sun. On the contrary, Xu Yuanchong's translation is more reasonable. He boldly makes a great change in word order and translates into more native English sentence which is conducive to the understanding and acceptance of the foreign language readers. In a word, when translating Chinese ancient poems, translators should give play to their creative

treason and adopt flexible translation methods. Translated version should not be controlled by the poem form. Because it is the last resort for translators to reproduce the original poems fluently. Just like what Xu Yuanchong does in this poem, he makes his translated version more native even if he adjusts the word order.

5.2 Foreignization

Venuti (1995) said “foreignization pushes the readers towards the author.” Owing to differences between Chinese and English, literary translation sometimes should get close to the culture of the source language, undertake the responsibility of spreading source culture, and introduce it to the target language countries. In translation, some Chinese elements are consciously preserved. In other words, Chinese culture should not be fully covered by western culture. Foreignization manifests itself in transliteration, transplant of image, consistency of word order. The following examples are given:

5.2.1 Transliteration

Transliteration is often used in translating places names, personal names and some words with specific cultural meaning, such as: 饺子 (jiaozi), 荔枝 (lizhi), 旗袍 (chipao), 道教 (Taoism), 功夫 (kongfu) and so forth.

Example 1

故垒西边，人道是，三国周郎赤壁。

Kenneth Rexroth (1971):

To the West of the ancient
Wall you enter the Red Gorge
Of Chu Ko Liang of the
Days of the Three Kingdoms.

Xu Yuanchong (1982):

West of the ancient fortress appears

Red Cliff where General Zhou won his early fame
When the Three Kingdoms were in flame.

There are many places or person names in Su Shi's poems. Translators adopt different translation methods under different circumstances. For example, omission methods are adopted to lower the strangeness of culture. Transliteration methods provide the foreigners with a chance to touch the real Chinese culture. “周郎” refers to “Zhou Yu”, that is, “General Zhou”. Xu Yuanchong adopts transliteration and translates into “General Zhou” and Kenneth Rexroth also uses transliteration. But unfortunately he mistranslates into “Chu Ko Liang” due to his misreading of the original poem. As we can see, the two translators both adopt transliteration methods to represent the image of “Zhou Yu”.

Example 2

恰似姮娥怜双燕，分明照、画梁斜。

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

Maybe Chang-O the moon goddess will pity this single swallow
and join us together with the cord of light
that reaches beneath the painted eaves of your home.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

The Moon Goddess seems to care for the swallows in pair.
She sheds her light into their dream on painted beam.

Kenneth Rexroth translates “姮娥” into “Chang-O the moon goddess”. He uses transliteration and annotation, which is conducive to the spread of Chinese culture. While Xu Yuanchong translates into “the Moon Goddess”. He adopts annotation which is beneficial to the reading habits of the foreigners. However, as to the spread of Chinese culture, the translation of Kenneth Rexroth is more advocated.

5.2.2 Transplant of Image

When there are cultural defaults in the targeted languages, translators can “transplant” the original image into the target language. Such translation can not only preserve the original culture images with Chinese flavor but also enrich corpus of target language.

Example 1

纵使相逢应不识，尘满面，鬓如霜。

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Revived, e'en if she be, oh, could she still know me?

My face is worn with care.

And frosted is my hair.

Burton Watson(1966):

Even if we met you wouldn't know me,

Dust on my face,

Hair like frost-

The two scholars vary in translating “尘满面，鬓如霜”. Xu Yuanchong translates into “my face is worn with care, and frosted is my hair.” While Burton Watson translates into “dust on my face, hair like frost.” It is worth mentioning that the two translators transplant the image of “霜” in their versions. Chinese poets have a preference on frost in the ancient poetry, such as “何处得秋霜” and “艰难苦恨繁双鬓”. Chinese poets tend to express their feelings in an implicit way. They pursue a more implicit beauty with euphemistic words or phrases. For example, they call white hair “shuangbin”. It is used so frequently that Chinese readers are familiar with such euphemistic expression. On the contrary, English writers are relatively straightforward and realistic in expressions, such as the famous English poem *When You Are Old* written by William Butler Yeats. In this poem, he uses “when you are old and gray” to express “当你老了，头发花白”. From this version, we can learn that the foreigners tend

to express their feelings in a straightforward way. Such translation is in accordance with reading habits of foreigners. The two translators both translate “霜” into frost and introduce the unfamiliar culture image to the English readers and convey the implicit characteristics of Chinese poems. In short, “frost” is much richer in poetic flavor than “gray hair”. It is obvious that such translation caters to the style of the original poem.

Example 2

春色三分，二分尘土，一分流水。

Hans H. Frankel(1976):

Of all the colors of spring,
Two thirds become dust,
One third flowing water.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Of spring's three graces,
Two have gone with the roadside dust,
And one with waves.

“春色”means the scenery of spring. “春色” “秋色” often appear in Chinese poems, that is the scenery of spring or autumn, which is very familiar to Chinese translators. Xu Yuanchong translates into “the spring's graces”, which is more appropriate. Hans H. Frankel translates into “the colors of spring”. It is a mismatch with the original poem. Here Xu Yuanchong consciously preserves the image and gives the foreigners a fresh experience when reading. In a word, translators should flexibly introduce native culture to the foreigners in order to promote the exchange and integration of different cultures.

Example 3

乱石穿空，惊涛拍岸，卷起千堆雪。

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

Jagged peaks pierce the heavens.

The furious rapids beat
At the boat, and dash up in
A thousand clouds of spray like snow.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Jagged rocks tower in the air
And swashing waves beat on the shore,
Rolling up a thousand heaps of snow.

These lines describe magnificent scene of Chibi. The first sentence represents “high mountain”, the second sentence “urgent water”, the third sentence “big wave”. Xu Yuanchong translates “卷起千堆雪” into “rolling up a thousand heaps of snow”. He selects a noun “heaps” to reproduces the magnificence of the waves in Chibi vividly. Besides, he also uses three verbs “tower” “beat” and “rolling up” in his translation, which gets closer to source language and provides a chance for westerners to appreciate the beauty of Chinese poem. Last but not least, he selects “a thousand heaps of snow” to reproduce the powerful picture and the great waves before the Su Shi’s eyes. Comparing with Kenneth Rexroth’s translation “like snow”, Xu Yuanchong elides the preposition “like” and makes his version closer to the writing features of Chinese. Suffice it to say, foreignization translation should be encouraged to some extent to spread the characteristics and connotation of Chinese culture. In addition to this, there is a mismatch in Kenneth Rexroth’s translation “the furious rapids beat at the boat”. He mistranslates “岸” into “boat”.

Example 4

人生如梦，一尊还酹江月。

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

My answer is a wine cup,
Full of the moon drowned in the river.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Life is but like a passing dream.

Moon, I drink to you who saw them on the stream.

These lines reflect author's emotional ups and downs and his open-minded feelings after the fierce conflicts between the ideal and reality in his heart. The author feels shameful when compared with the hero. But life is short, he doesn't let sorrow linger in his mind, which reflects his positive attitude towards life. “人生如梦” means that the life is as short as a dream, which paves the way for the later sentence “一樽还酹江月”. Xu Yuanchong uses “passing dream” to signify the shortness of life. “酹”, also known as libation, refers to an ancient sacrifice activity with distinctive Chinese characteristics. As we know, China is one of the first winemaking countries in the world with a long history of wine culture. In ancient times people pour wine on the ground to sacrifice or swear. Owing to the literature characteristics of poems, they gradually become the most important carriers of wine culture. Xu Yuanchong selects the verb “drink to” to reproduce the action of “酹”. Obviously, such translation is more appropriate than Kenneth Rexroth's version “a wine cup”. Drinking with the moon delivers a candid and open-minded feeling in ancient Chinese poem. Kenneth Rexroth's translation “drown” wrongly portrays a man who hesitates at the edge of the river with a wine cup in his hand, which is not consistent with the style of the original poem. His translation fails to show Su Shi's positive attitude towards life, and thus causing loss and deformation of cultural information.

5.2.3 Consistency of Word Order

Grammatically, word order refers to the sequence of different elements in a sentence or the arrangement of the sentence constituents. To some extent, word order reflects national customs and thinking models of different countries. As we know, there are many differences between Chinese and English, especially the word order. Translation, as a bridge

between the two cultures, plays an important role in communication. From the translated texts, we can find some examples showing the influence of Chinese on English at sentence level. Here are some examples:

Example 1

不恨此花飞尽，恨西园落红难缀。

Hans H. Frankel(1976):

I don't regret that these blossoms have all flown away,
I regret that in the West garden
the fallen red petals are hard to gather.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

Grieve not for willow catkins flown away,
But that in Western Garden fallen petals red can't be restored.

“此花” refers to “杨柳” in this poem. “杨柳” is one of the most common images in classical poetry. From these lines, we can know that Su Shi sighs for the passing of spring when he sees the falling catkins, which reflects his cherishing for spring. Xu Yuanchong adopts foreignization method especially in the word order. His translation gets closer to the source language and give the foreigners an unprecedented experience of reading. He selects “grieve not” to express the meaning of “不恨”. And “西园落红难缀” shares the same word order with “in Western Garden fallen petals red can't be restored”. Suffice it to say, his translation does not cater to the reading habits of the foreigners but pushing them towards the author. “We are inspired by the beauty of literally translated poems which are strange but graceful” (Zhao, 1985, p.229). Keeping the same word order with the source language plays an important role in cultural communication and transmission, which can be regarded as a typical method of foreignization strategy.

Example 2

江山如画，一时多少豪杰。

Kenneth Rexroth(1971):

Mountain and river have often been painted,
In the memory of the heroes of those days.

Xu Yuanchong(1982):

To match the hills and the river so fair,
How many heroes brave of yore made a great show!

In this sentence, the author firstly praises the great nature, and then the great heroes. In China, in order to express their feelings, poets often describe scenery first. Therefore, the description of the scenery often paves the way for the poets' thoughts and feelings, which is also due to Chinese literati's preference on implicitness. Xu Yuanchong selects the verb "match" to make his translation more logical and fluent. Besides, "how many heroes brave of yore made a great show!" roughly shares the same word order with the original sentence "一时多少豪杰". Suffice it to say, Xu Yuanchong's translation conforms to the writing characteristics of ancient Chinese Poetry with clear structure and emotions. Imbued with the influence of cultural globalization, foreigners are more tolerant towards different cultures. Translators could give full play to his creative treason and skillfully utilize foreignization strategy when translating. Apparently, there is mismatch in Kenneth Rexroth's translation "mountain and river have often been painted". "江山如画" is Su Shi's praise towards the scenery of Chibi. Kenneth Rexroth mixes the Chinese characters "如" with "入", which leads to misreading.

Chapter Six Conclusion

Su Shi is hailed as an outstanding literary master in Chinese history with numerous poems. The study on his poems provides us with more inspiration and enlightenment for further development of literary translation. Medio-translatology, put forward by Xie Tianzhen, makes a new perspective available for us to have a comprehensive understanding of the translation of Su Shi's poems.

Firstly, literary translation acts as a cross-cultural communication in which collision, distortion and integration are inevitable. Literary is also a creative activity, which could make the original viable in new countries and cultures. Creative treason can be found in numerous English versions of Su Shi's poems. Creative treason is embodied in content treason and form treason. In terms of content treason, different expressions have been analyzed in this thesis from four aspects, namely, translation of four-character structure, culture-loaded words, cultural images and sentences without subject. In terms of form treason, it is manifested in two styles of renditions of Su Shi's poems, namely, metrical poetry and free verse.

Secondly, creative treason is indispensable in translating Su Shi's poems. His poems extremely vary in themes and are written in a vigorous and fluent style, brimming with talent and wisdom, thus raising a great challenge to translators. With different cultural backgrounds, translators usually have their unique understanding of the original work. And then they represent the original poem in accordance with their creativity and wits. In conversion of two languages, mistranslation occurs inevitably. Mistranslation precisely reveals the conflicts during the communication of two languages. For this reason, mistranslation often carries special research value.

Thirdly, under the guidance of Medio-translatology theory, translators interpret Su Shi's poems in many creative ways which can be classified into two strategies, namely, domestication and foreignization. Domestication is creatively employed in English versions of Su Shi's poems, such as omission, addition, free translation, substitution of image, adjustment of word order, paraphrase of sentence and free verse in form. Foreignization manifests itself in transliteration, transplant of image, consistency of word order and metrical poetry in form. Above all, flexible utilization of translation methods reflects creative treason of translators differing in nationality, country and cultural tradition.

Besides, there are some deficiencies and limitations in this thesis. Firstly, due to the limited words, some other representative poems of Su Shi could not be introduced to the readers. And some detailed information could not be elaborated fully in this thesis owing to words limitation. In this regard, it is not a comprehensive study on English versions of Su Shi's poems. Secondly, due to the limitation of time and energy, the writer could not totally acquire relative data and books. Because some English versions of Su Shi's poems are very rare and difficult to find, or very expensive, especially versions translated by the foreigners.

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攻读硕士学位期间发表的论文及科研成果

发表的论文：

- 1 张佳月，功能对等视角下浅析《德伯家的苔丝》汉译，海外英语，2017 年 13 期：91 页-92 页，主办单位：安徽科学技术出版社。
- 2 张佳月，李芳芳。译介学视角下的宋词文化负载词英译研究，北方文学，2017 年 7 月：229 页+268 页，主办单位：黑龙江省作家协会。

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- 2 “一带一路”战略背景下四川非物质文化遗产旅游英译研究——以四川皮影戏英译为例，项目编号：ycjj2017020。

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